

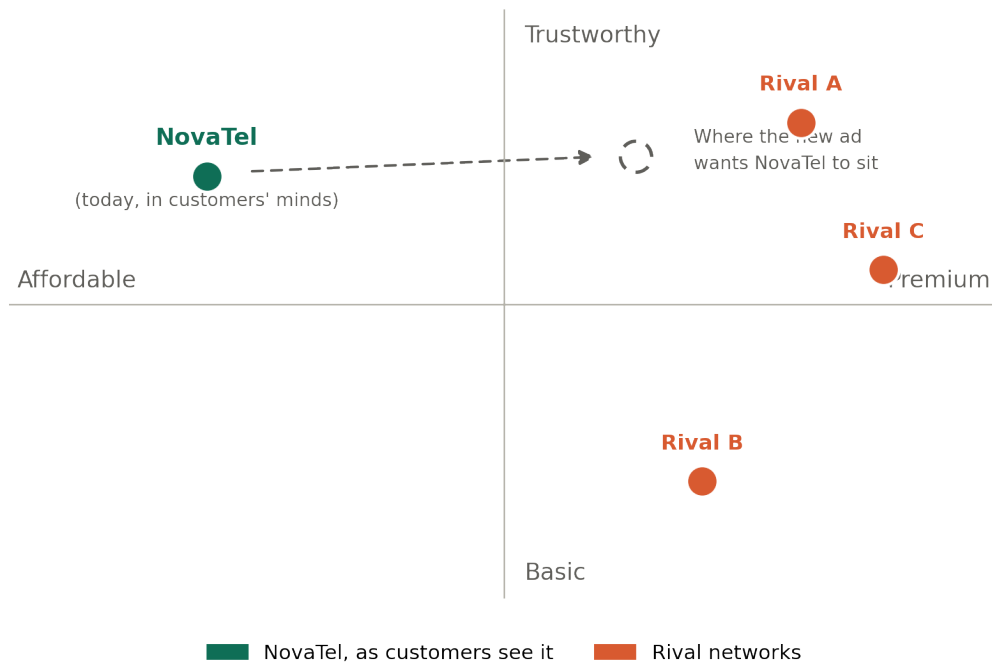
NovaTel case, solved

Sales & Marketing case study | Framework: STP + Positioning map

The framework, in plain words

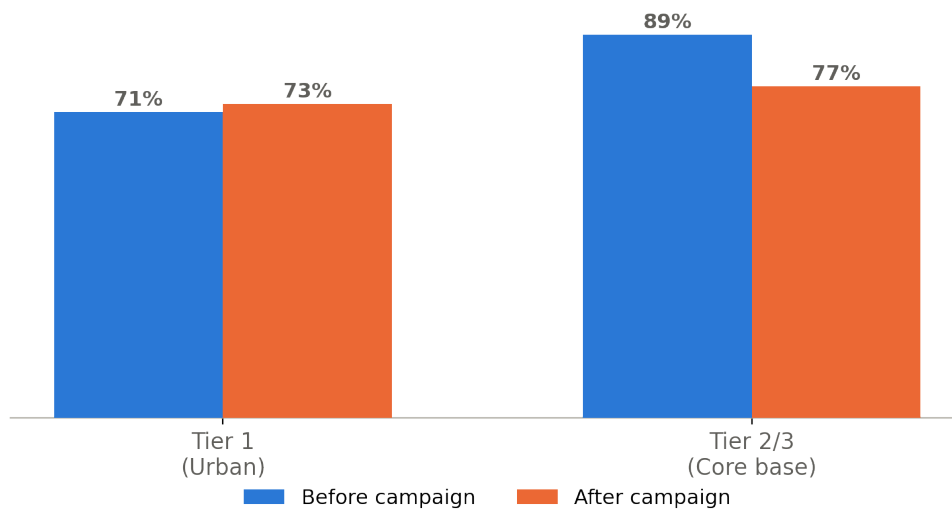
STP means Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning. First you split customers into groups. Then you pick the group you want to win. Then you decide the one clear promise you make to that group. A positioning map is just a picture that checks if your promise matches what customers already believe about you.

Where NovaTel really stands



Customers already see NovaTel as affordable and trustworthy, a space no rival owns. The new ad is pulling NovaTel toward premium, straight into a corner where three rivals already live. That is a hard fight to win, and it puts NovaTel's safest space at risk.

What happened to renewals



Urban renewals barely moved, up just 2 points. But the loyal core base dropped 12 points in three weeks. The campaign is already costing more than it has gained anywhere.

Q1. Push on, or reverse the campaign?

Neither. A full reversal wastes the money already spent and looks like panic. But running the same campaign everywhere for months would let the bleeding continue. The fix is to pause the campaign in tier-2 and tier-3 towns right away, since it was never meant for them, and keep testing it only in big cities.

Q2. Can one brand serve both groups?

Yes, but not with one single message. Airlines do this well: budget seats and business class sit under one airline, but they never mix their messaging. NovaTel can keep its main brand affordable and trustworthy for its loyal base, and launch a separate premium name, like “NovaTel Prime,” for city professionals. Two audiences, two promises, one company.

Q3. What should Rhea tell the board?

Lead with the data, not the anecdote. Show the positioning map: NovaTel is repositioning into a crowded space while giving up an empty one. Show the renewal drop: real cost, no gain yet. Recommend pausing the campaign in core towns immediately, and testing a separate premium sub-brand in cities for one more quarter, with renewal numbers tracked by tier this time.

The one-line takeaway

This was not a failed repositioning. It was an unsegmented one. Fix the targeting, keep the ambition.